KILN / PRODUCT & EXPERIENCE SPECIFICATION

The Proprietary High-End Game Hub

A full product, UX, visual design, technical, quality, and launch blueprint for a premium-feeling gaming destination. Kiln is centrally owned and curated: no public developer submissions, no open marketplace, and no creator portal.

Product rule: The owner develops, commissions, selects, licenses, tests, and publishes the games. Players experience one coherent product—not a catalogue of unrelated uploads.

FOUNDATION	DECISION
Ownership	Single-owner, centrally controlled catalogue
Game sources	Owner-developed, commissioned under contract, or explicitly licensed
Experience goal	High-end UI/UX and game quality before catalogue scale
Core advantage	Curated quality, excellent presentation, dependable play
Primary platform	Android-first; tablet adaptation considered from the start
Document scope	Product, card design, discovery, architecture, performance, QA, launch

Version 2.0 • 10 October 2026 • Proposed specification; not a claim that features are already shipped.

Blueprint map

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1. Product definition and ownership

Kiln is a curated gaming destination that makes every game feel deliberately selected and every screen feel intentional. Its advantage is not simply the number of games. It is the quality of the games, the presentation, the ease of discovery, and the confidence that tapping Play will work.

Locked ownership model

- There is no public developer submission portal, developer account system, creator marketplace, or open publishing pipeline.
- The owner controls catalogue selection, game concepts, development priorities, release timing, branding, and quality standards.
- Games may be built in-house, commissioned under contract, or included under an explicit licence defining distribution and commercial rights.
- Do not show public-facing 'submit a game', 'publish with us', or creator recruitment flows.
- Do not build systems for open submissions unless the product direction explicitly changes in the future.

Product promise

Discover a game worth your time. Understand it immediately. Start playing without friction. Return without confusion.

What Kiln is not

- Not an open marketplace of unrelated uploads.
- Not a giant grid padded with weak games.
- Not a social network with empty feeds or fake activity.
- Not a launcher that invents offline, cloud-save, or controller claims.
- Not a glossy shell that hides mediocre gameplay.

2. Experience principles and quality bar

Dimension	Required standard	Reject
Visual craft	Consistent typography, spacing, contrast, art direction	Random radii, mixed icon styles, excessive glow
Hierarchy	One clear focal point per section	Every element competing for attention
Interaction	Predictable actions, instant feedback, correct Back behavior	Dead controls, surprise routes, tiny hit targets
Content	Real gameplay art and accurate descriptions	Placeholder art presented as real
Performance	Stable scrolling and recoverable launches	Jank, layout jumps, endless spinners
Trust	Honest saves, offline, device and price labels	Unsupported claims or hidden limitations

Design review rule: if a visual effect, badge, border, animation or label does not improve comprehension, confidence, delight or brand recognition, remove it.

3. Information architecture and navigation

Destination	Role	Contents
Home	Curated starting point	Featured game, Continue Playing, editorial shelves, recent additions
Discover	Intentional browsing	Search, genres, collections, moods, filters
Library	Player's game space	Favourites, recently played, availability and downloads if supported
Challenges	Optional repeat-play	Personal goals and supported achievements; hide until meaningful
Profile / Settings	Controls and support	Preferences, privacy, accessibility, help, account only if needed

Navigation rules

- Use only destinations that have real content. If Challenges is not ready, do not show an empty tab.

- Keep navigation stable; preserve scroll position when switching top-level destinations.
- Show selection through icon, label and contrast—not colour alone.
- The curved navigation can remain a subtle brand signature, but must not steal content height or create an unwanted divider line.
- Android Back dismisses overlays and returns through the actual navigation history.
- Search must be reachable from the main browsing experience.

4. Home screen specification

Order	Module	Rules
1	Compact brand header	Wordmark, search and profile/settings; no oversized dead space
2	Featured game	One strong image, title, specific gameplay hook, genre and primary Play action
3	Quick categories	Compact horizontally scrollable chips/icons with clear selection
4	Continue Playing	Only genuinely launched games; truthful resume state
5	Editorial collection	A meaningful point of view, not a generic shelf
6	New to Kiln	Only genuinely new or updated games; badge is time-aware
7	More to explore	Varied games; avoid repeating the same titles across shelves

Featured module

- Use authentic game art or approved key art based on the actual game.
- Protect one focal subject; place copy over a controlled scrim or a separate text zone.
- Use title, one concise gameplay promise, genre and one primary CTA.
- Do not stack ratings, badges and competing buttons.
- Carousels should be user-controlled or slow and accessible, with visible position indicators.
- Reserve image dimensions so the page never jumps while artwork loads.

Feed pacing

- The first useful game shelf should appear without excessive scrolling on common phone sizes.
- Do not make every row horizontal: mix a hero, a compact shelf and a purposeful grid.
- Hide or redesign a shelf that has too few games instead of padding it with filler.
- Collection titles should explain why the games belong together.

5. High-end game card system

Game cards are the most important reusable visual component in Kiln. They should feel like carefully art-directed covers, not generic app tiles. Artwork leads; metadata supports; the action is obvious without clutter.

Card family	Use	Composition
Feature	Headline game	Wide art, controlled overlay, title, short hook, primary CTA
Continue	Resume a game	Artwork, title, true progress or last played, resume action
Editorial landscape	Premium discovery shelves	Wide crop, focal point, consistent title zone and one metadata line
Compact portrait	Two-column grid	Tall key art, restrained overlay, title and genre
Search result	Dense results	Small cover, title, category and verified compatibility details
Coming soon	Not yet playable	Distinct unavailable state; no misleading Play CTA

Artwork rules

- Use a fixed aspect ratio for each card family; do not let card heights vary arbitrarily.

- Use current, authentic gameplay screenshots or approved key art; never imply a scene exists when it does not.
- Define crop-safe areas and validate landscape, portrait and narrow-screen crops.
- Use overlays only to protect legibility; avoid crushing the image with heavy black gradients.
- Use consistent corner-radius tokens; avoid layered borders, thick outlines and heavy shadows everywhere.
- Load resized images and stable placeholders at the same dimensions as final artwork.

Metadata hierarchy

Primary: game title. **Secondary:** genre or one useful attribute. **Optional:** one verified label such as Offline, Controller, New or Updated. Everything else belongs on the detail page.

Interaction contract

- The card body opens details. A separate Play/Resume button may launch directly only when its meaning is unmistakable.
- Never make a tiny icon the only way to open a game.
- Show immediate pressed feedback, then a short consistent transition.
- Optional long-press menu: Favourite, Remove from Continue Playing, Details. Essential actions must not live only in long press.
- Loading, updating, unavailable and error states must be visually distinct.
- Support keyboard/controller focus if those inputs are in scope.

Card anti-patterns

- Unreadably small text; fake progress bars; fabricated ratings/player counts; badge stacks; inconsistent CTA placement; autoplay previews with sound or data use without consent.

6. Game detail and pre-play confidence

Zone	Specification
Top media	Real screenshots or gameplay clip, clear Back control and media position indicator
Title block	Title, category, concise premise, favourite action
Primary action	Play / Install / Continue / Update / Unavailable based on actual state
Quick facts	Offline, size, orientation, controller support, ads/IAP and age suitability
Gameplay pitch	Two to four lines explaining the real loop and what makes it distinct
Screenshots	Current, representative, correctly labelled if pre-release
Save / availability	Local/cloud/unknown save state, network requirement and compatibility
Related games	Relevant by mechanic or mood; avoid repetitive cross-promotion

- State whether a download, account, purchase, network connection or permission is required before the player commits.
- Surface essentials without a wall of technical text; details can expand on demand.
- If the device cannot run a game, explain why and offer an alternative.
- First-run downloads show size, progress, cancel and safe resume.
- Launch failures keep the player in context with Retry, Details and Report a problem.

7. Discovery, search and collections

Search

- Search titles, genres, mechanics, moods and supported tags; tolerate minor spelling errors.
- Keep recent searches locally with a clear erase option.
- Keep result row dimensions stable while loading.
- Empty results explain the state and offer filter reset or related categories.

Filters

Filter	Definition
Genre	Real categories present in the catalogue
Session length	Quick, medium or long based on tested play
Offline	Verified offline play after required setup
Input	Touch, controller or keyboard where supported
Orientation	Portrait, landscape or flexible
Install size	Approximate current storage footprint
Cost model	Free, paid, ads, IAP or membership requirement
Accessibility	Only features implemented and tested

Editorial collections

• Good in five minutes • One more run • Think it through • Offline favourites • Made for a controller • New on Kiln

Collections should be curated and refreshed intentionally. Do not create dozens of near-identical categories to make the product appear larger.

8. Library, history and progress

- Favourites are explicitly chosen and work without an account.
- Continue Playing includes only games actually launched—not games whose detail page was merely opened.
- Show progress only when a reliable game integration supplies it; otherwise show last played.
- Distinguish local game data from cloud-synced progress in plain language.
- For local-only saves, explain that uninstalling or clearing data may remove progress.
- For cloud saves, show last successful sync and resolve conflicts instead of silently overwriting.
- Clearing history must not accidentally delete game saves.
- Keep removed/unavailable games in history with an honest status where practical.

9. Proprietary game development pipeline

The catalogue is managed internally. There is no public submission system.

Stage	Required work	Exit condition
Concept	Core loop, audience, originality, scope, art direction, feasibility	Approved concept brief
Prototype	Playable loop, controls, fun test, performance risks	Core loop merits production
Production	Art, audio, progression, menus, accessibility, settings	Feature-complete candidate
QA	Crash, save, offline, interruption, input, screen-size and performance tests	No blocker defects
Presentation	Card art, screenshots, trailer, description and verified labels	Media matches actual game
Release	Version, changelog, compatibility, rollback and monitoring	Release gate approved
Maintenance	Feedback, crashes, balance, compatibility and content updates	Fix, improve or retire

Per-game dossier

- Game ID, ownership/source, rights record, version history and internal maintainer.
- Supported Android versions/devices, memory expectations, orientation and input modes.
- Network, permissions, ads, purchases, analytics and third-party SDK inventory.
- Save/offline behavior, content rating, support route and known issues.
- Approved art, screenshots, trailer, description and verified feature labels.

10. Visual design system

Use a restrained dark foundation, violet for primary actions, cyan for secondary emphasis, and warm gold only for premium/reward moments. Let game art provide most of the colour and personality.

Token	Starting value	Use
Background	#07101E	Main canvas
Surface	#101C31	Cards and navigation
Raised surface	#192841	Sheets and focused panels
Primary	#6557FF	Main CTA and selected state
Secondary	#45C4D7	Supporting emphasis
Reward / premium	#F0C75E	Rare highlight only
Primary text	#F5F7FC	Headings and key labels
Secondary text	#AAB8CC	Descriptions and metadata
Radius	12 / 18 / 26 dp	Chips / cards / hero
Spacing	4 / 8 / 12 / 16 / 24 / 32 dp	Layout rhythm

Typography and icons

- Use at most one display family and one body family. Reserve distinctive display typography for hero moments.
- Suggested sizes: hero 28–34sp, section 20–24sp, card title 15–18sp, body 14–16sp, metadata 12–14sp.
- Support font scaling and long strings; never bake critical text into artwork.
- Use one icon family and consistent stroke weights. Label unfamiliar icons.
- Important actions should have practical 48dp touch targets and adequate separation.

Depth and surfaces

- Choose subtle elevation or border contrast as the main separator; avoid applying both heavily.
- Avoid glass effects over busy artwork if they reduce legibility.
- Reserve glow for featured or selected states, not every card.
- Integrate system bars without sacrificing contrast or touch area.

11. Interaction and motion

Interaction	Behavior
Screen transition	150–250 ms; consistent direction and easing
Tap feedback	Immediate pressed state; haptics only where meaningful
Image loading	Stable placeholder; no layout shift
Pull to refresh	Only on genuinely refreshable content
Dialogs/sheets	Focused decisions; avoid stacking overlays
Errors	Explain what happened and provide a next action
Reduced motion	Respect system preference and simplify transitions

Motion should explain state, progress or spatial continuity. It must not disguise slow loading or make every screen busy.

12. Accessibility and ergonomics

- Support TalkBack labels, meaningful reading order, headings and predictable focus.

- Never communicate state through colour alone.
- Test large font scaling, narrow screens, landscape, display cutouts and both Android navigation modes.
- Keep text away from highly detailed image regions; use contrast-tested scrims or separate text zones.
- Support reduced motion; do not rapidly auto-advance carousels.
- Test one-handed reach and keyboard/controller focus if those input methods are supported.

13. Android architecture and game delivery

Recommended native baseline: Kotlin, Jetpack Compose, lifecycle-aware state, repositories and a clear separation between Kiln catalogue/UI and the game runtime/launch layer.

Layer	Responsibility
UI	Compose screens, card components, navigation and visual states
Presentation	ViewModels, screen state and event handling
Domain	Search, filter, favourite, launch, continue and collection use cases
Data	Repositories, Room metadata/history, DataStore preferences, remote API if required
Runtime adapter	Controlled interface for launching/opening supported game types
Observability	Crash reporting, non-sensitive errors and performance traces

Implementation rules

- Keep expensive work off the main thread and never decode full-size art for tiny cards.
- Use paging, resized image assets, caching and stable list keys.
- Represent loading, success, empty, offline, unavailable and error states explicitly.
- Keep catalogue metadata separate from favourites/history so content updates do not erase user state.
- Never execute untrusted game code inside a privileged app process.

Game delivery model — decide before production

Model	UX implications	Trade-offs
Separate install/launch	Install handoff and app switching may occur	Clear isolation; less seamless continuity
Hosted/bundled native games	Potentially unified install and update experience	Higher signing, security and distribution burden
Embedded web games	Potentially fast start for small games	Variable performance, offline support and native feel

14. Performance and offline behavior

Area	Proposed target	Focus
Cold start	p95 ≤ 2.5 sec on defined mid-range device	Defer noncritical work
Warm start	p95 ≤ 1.2 sec	Restore state without blocking IO
Scrolling	Consistent 60 fps target	Sized images, stable keys, restrained effects
Crash-free sessions	Initial target ≥ 99.5%	Monitor by version and device class
Offline browse	Cached catalogue/library remain readable	Clear online-only state
Launch recovery	Every failure has a safe next action	Retry, details and report path
Battery/data	No constant polling; previews user-controlled	Cache and network budgets

These are proposed targets to validate, not guarantees. Test lower-memory phones and older Android versions within the declared support range.

15. Privacy, security and compliance

- Collect only data required for core functionality, reliability, billing or explicitly enabled features.
- Publish a privacy policy matching the app, integrated games, analytics and ad SDKs.
- Keep permissions minimal and request them in context.
- Verify current Google Play requirements for target API, data safety, payments, ads, age rating and game distribution model.
- Protect network traffic, restrict admin access, keep secrets out of source control and document incident response.
- Provide a visible route to report a broken game or content concern, despite having no public submission system.

16. Analytics and success metrics

North-star metric: weekly players who successfully launch a game through Kiln and return to play again.

Event	Meaning	Properties
home_view	Home opened	App version, session ID
game_impression	Card meaningfully visible	Game ID, shelf ID, position
game_detail_open	Detail opened	Game ID, source
play_tap	Launch requested	Game ID, launch mode
launch_result	Launch success/failure	Game ID, error class
favourite_change	Favourite added/removed	Game ID, action
search_submit	Search submitted	Query category; avoid sensitive raw text
session_end	Play session ended	Duration bucket, exit state if available
report_issue	Issue reported	Game ID, issue category

Measurement guardrails

- Measure successful launches and repeat play, not only card clicks.
- Track crashes, ANRs, launch failures, performance, battery/data complaints and support reports.
- Use aggregated analytics and set retention periods before shipping.
- Do not collect unrelated contacts, precise location, keystrokes or sensitive personal data.

17. Monetization and business rules

Model	Potential fit	Guardrails
Free with ads	Broad access to curated games	No deceptive close buttons or disruptive gameplay interruptions
Premium membership	Real benefits across multiple Kiln experiences	Clear recurring price, renewal, cancellation and restore
Paid games/upgrades	Premium experiences with explicit value	Show inclusions before purchase; handle billing failures
Sponsored placement	Only if commercially needed	Clearly labelled and separated from organic curation

- Use one understandable model at a time; validate value before adding complexity.
- Do not introduce virtual currencies or complex reward economies without a genuine need.
- Never use fake scarcity, false countdowns, misleading 'free' claims or shame-based cancellation.
- Paid placement must not quietly override editorial quality.

18. Roadmap and implementation order

Phase	Build	Exit criteria
0 — Decisions	Game delivery, catalogue scope, minimum Android version, rights and business model	Written decisions
1 — Design foundation	Tokens, navigation, card families, home, detail, discover and library prototypes	Real-content prototype tested
2 — Vertical slice	One game: discover → detail → launch → return → history	End-to-end flow reliable
3 — Catalogue foundation	Metadata, categories, favourites, search, image pipeline	No fake states; acceptable performance
4 — Private beta	Small polished catalogue, crash monitoring, offline states, help/report	Release gates pass
5 — Public release	Store listing, privacy disclosures, staged rollout, monitoring	Stable rollout and rollback ready
6 — Retention polish	Continue Playing, collections, challenges only if useful	Measured improvement

MVP scope

- Home, Discover/Search, Game Detail, Library/Favourites, Settings and Help/Report.
- Small but genuinely good catalogue; real artwork and verified metadata.
- Stable card layouts, loading/error/offline states and dependable launch handling.
- Crash/performance analytics and a tested rollback process.
- No public submission portal, creator dashboard, open marketplace or empty social feed.

19. QA and release gates

Device and state coverage

- Test supported Android versions, low-memory devices, screen sizes, cutouts, gesture and three-button navigation.
- Test airplane mode, flaky network, low storage, process death, background/foreground, audio focus, rotation and battery saver.
- Test large font scaling, TalkBack, contrast, reduced motion and focus navigation.
- Upgrade the app without losing favourites/history; confirm catalogue updates do not corrupt local state.

Per-game tests

- First launch/relaunch, pause/resume, exit/back, interruptions and return to Kiln.
- Offline behavior, permissions, reconnect recovery, download cancellation/resume.
- Save creation, migration, recovery and clear-data behavior.
- Input modes, orientation, screen ratios, performance, audio and purchase/ad flows if present.

Gate	Pass condition
Game quality	Core loop is complete; no blocker defects
Presentation	Cards, screenshots and labels match the shipped build
Reliability	Crash, launch and performance results meet agreed thresholds
Truthfulness	Offline/save/controller/size/price labels verified
Privacy	Data inventory, SDK review and disclosures complete
Operations	Support, monitoring, rollback and game-disable procedure tested

20. Risks and acceptance checklist

Risk	Mitigation
Glossy shell, weak games	Test gameplay early; improve or retire weak titles
Over-designed cards	Prioritize artwork and hierarchy; remove decorative noise
Unclear delivery model	Decide early and design around it
Inconsistent game art	Create templates and crop-safe art direction
Low-end performance	Set support matrix and measure continuously
False save claims	Show only verified progress and save states
Catalogue feels small	Use strong editorial collections; never add filler
Monetization damages trust	Clear labels, simple terms and restrained placements

Decisions to lock

- Separate install/launch, hosted native games or embedded runtime?
- Which games are owned, commissioned or licensed?
- What minimum Android version is actually tested?
- Are accounts required at launch, and for what player benefit?
- Is monetization included in v1 or postponed?
- What art direction governs game art, thumbnails, screenshots and trailers?
- What device matrix and performance thresholds define release-ready?

Definition of done

- A new player can find a promising game within 30 seconds.
- Every card is legible, consistent, artwork-led and clearly tappable.
- The detail page explains gameplay and requirements without overwhelming the player.
- Browse → play → return works reliably on supported devices.
- The library never invents progress or misrepresents save behavior.
- The app feels cohesive because of deliberate rules, not piles of effects.
- Only owner-developed, owner-commissioned or explicitly licensed games appear.

End of blueprint. Numerical targets and implementation choices are proposals to validate—not claims about a shipped product.